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DEBATING
SOCIETY**



NEDMUN VI

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NED University of Engineering & Technology (Main Campus), Karachi

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SOCIAL, CULTURAL & HUMANITARIAN COMMITTEE

- A) Balancing cultural preservation with the effects of globalization
- B) The Role of Social Media in Shaping Public Opinion and Human Rights

SOCHUM

Socials, Cultural & Humanitarian Committee

Introduction and Mandate of Committee

Mandate:

- SOCHUM (UN GA Third Committee) addresses social, humanitarian, and cultural issues, including human rights, vulnerable groups, and cultural heritage.
- Coordinates with UNESCO, OHCHR, UNHCR, and other agencies.

Past Agenda Items:

- Rights of indigenous peoples
- Elimination of racism, xenophobia
- Protection of migrants
- Promotion of cultural diversity

Relevance of Topic:

- Globalization affects cultural rights, identity, and minority/indigenous communities.
- Focus is on human and social dimensions, not only technical heritage management.

Purpose of Discussion:

- Safeguard cultural diversity amid globalization, digital change, and socio-economic shifts.
- Develop rights-based frameworks preserving heritage while supporting global participation.

Delegates' Objectives:

- Propose international cooperation to protect heritage and languages.
- Recommend funding and capacity-building for endangered practices.
- Develop multilateral frameworks supporting cultural rights alongside globalization.
- Encourage monitoring systems for at-risk cultural traditions.

Expected Outputs:

- Draft resolutions/frameworks committing to cultural protection, integrating heritage in development, coordinating with UNESCO, and supporting community-led initiatives.

Off-topic Issues to Avoid:

- Trade rules or financial globalization unrelated to cultural impact.

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SOCHUM Agenda: A

Balancing cultural preservation with the effects of globalization.

1. Introduction to the topic:**Cultural Preservation:**

- Tangible: monuments, artifacts
- Intangible: languages, rituals, knowledge systems
- Protecting communities' cultural identity

Globalization:

- Increases cultural exchange but risks dominance of global products over local practices.

Global Concerns:

- Declining cultural diversity (~50% of 7,000 languages endangered)
- Cultural homogenization
- Indigenous/minority groups disproportionately at risk
- Threats from conflict, climate change, displacement
- Recognition of cultural rights as human rights

Stakeholders:

- **International organizations:** UNESCO, OHCHR, UNDP, UNHCR
- **Nation-states:** Set cultural policies, integrate heritage in development
- **Indigenous & minority communities:** Custodians of traditions
- **Civil society & NGOs:** Heritage preservation
- **Private sector:** Media, tourism, tech influence cultural representation

Trends & Urgency:

- Digital globalization reshapes cultural exchange
- Urbanization reduces intergenerational transmission
- Tourism, migration affect identity
- Economic globalization pressures local industries

Diplomatic Framing:

- Promote globalization benefits (dialogue, knowledge exchange) while safeguarding cultural diversity and rights

2. History and Background

A. Early Cultural Exchange (Pre-20th Century)

- Trade routes (Silk Road, Indian Ocean) → exchange of goods, religions, languages, arts
- Colonial expansion (16th–20th c.) → European languages/religions imposed, indigenous cultures suppressed

B. Nation-State Formation & Cultural Identity (19th–20th Century)

- Nationalism linked culture to political legitimacy; minority/regional cultures marginalized
- Industrialization, urbanization, mass media weakened rural traditions

C. Post-WWII & UN System (1945–1970s)

- UN & UNESCO: cultural reconstruction, literacy, cooperation
- Decolonization revived cultural sovereignty
- **Legal milestones:**
 - 1954 Hague Convention – cultural property in armed conflict
 - 1972 World Heritage Convention – outstanding heritage protection

D. Late 20th Century Globalization (1980s–2000s)

- Mass media, market liberalization, urbanization, Internet → global dominance & homogenization
- UN response: 2003 ICH Convention → recognized rituals, oral practices, craftsmanship; emphasized community participation

E. 21st Century Globalization (2000s–2020s)

- Digital platforms favor dominant languages/content
- Climate change threatens sites and living heritage
- Mass tourism → commodification
- Migration/displacement weaken continuity
- Armed conflicts target heritage (e.g., Timbuktu, Syria)

F. UN Governance & Cultural Rights (2000s–Present)

- Key frameworks:
 - 2001 Universal Declaration on Cultural Diversity
 - 2005 Convention on Cultural Expressions
 - UN Special Rapporteur on Cultural Rights (2009)
 - 2030 Agenda (SDGs 4, 11, 16)

Historical Turning Points Summary:

- Early intercultural trade – mutual exchange
- Colonial domination – coercive transformation
- Post-war UN heritage regimes

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- Mass media & digital globalization
 - Expansion of cultural rights frameworks

3. Causes

Executive Summary:

Globalization pressures on cultural preservation stem from *economic, political, social, technological, and environmental dynamics*. These forces interact across global, national, and local levels, disproportionately affecting indigenous and minority communities.

A. Structural Causes

- **Economic globalization**
 - Multinational competition undermines traditional cultural economies
 - Decline of artisanal livelihoods
- **Urbanization**
 - Migration reduces daily use of heritage languages and practices
- **Global media dominance**
 - Cultural homogenization via limited-language platforms

B. Political and Governance Causes

- Weak or poorly enforced cultural protection laws
- Colonial legacies disrupting cultural governance
- Centralized nation-building policies marginalizing minorities

C. Social Causes

- Breakdown in intergenerational transmission
- Forced migration and displacement
- Preference for economically dominant languages

D. Technological Causes

- Digital divide limiting cultural visibility
- Algorithmic bias favoring dominant cultures
- Loss of contextual meaning through digitization

E. Economic Drivers

- Competition from mass-produced goods
- Cultural commodification through tourism and entertainment

F. Regional Vulnerabilities

- **SIDS:** climate displacement and tourism dependency
- **Indigenous peoples:** land loss, marginalization, limited protections
- **Conflict zones:** intentional heritage destruction

Summary of Causes

- Economic pressure on traditional livelihoods
- Media and digital dominance
- Policy and governance gaps
- Migration, conflict, and climate change
- Unequal access to technology and representation

4. Effects

Executive Summary:

Globalization's effects on cultural preservation are multidimensional—producing both opportunity and risk. Without inclusive governance, globalization accelerates cultural loss, inequality, and insecurity.

A. Humanitarian and Social Effects

- Language extinction and loss of oral traditions
- Marginalization of indigenous and minority groups

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- Weakened social cohesion and cultural identity
 - Erosion of cultural rights and mental well-being

B. Economic Effects

- Decline of traditional livelihoods
- Over-commercialization of culture through tourism
- Unequal distribution of economic benefits

C. Technological Effects

- Digital cultural homogenization
- Cultural appropriation and IP violations
- Representation gaps due to digital exclusion

D. Effects on Specific Groups

- **Youth:** reduced engagement with heritage practices
- **Women:** loss of traditional transmission roles
- **SIDS:** climate-induced cultural displacement
- **Conflict-affected communities:** destruction of cultural memory

E. Geopolitical Effects

- Cultural diplomacy and soft-power competition
- Diplomatic tensions over misrepresentation
- Political instrumentalization of heritage

F. Security Effects

- Targeting of cultural sites as war crimes
- Illicit trafficking of cultural property

Summary of Effects

- Cultural homogenization and heritage loss
- Economic and social marginalization

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- Digital inequality
 - Geopolitical and security risks

7. Current Situation (2022–2025)

Executive Summary:

Globalization reshapes cultural identities via digital expansion, migration, economic integration, climate change, and conflict. UN initiatives and state policies address challenges, but gaps remain in digital equity, legal protection, funding, and community-led safeguarding.

A. Global Trends

- **Digital acceleration:** ~5.4 billion online; ~2.6 billion offline, mostly rural/indigenous → cultural invisibility.
- **Language endangerment:** Decline due to urbanization, migration, global media dominance.
- **Cultural industry concentration:** Few global media producers → homogenization.
- **Conflict-related destruction:** Ukraine, Sudan, Yemen, Sahel, Myanmar damage cultural sites/practices.

B. Climate and Environmental Pressures

- Climate-driven displacement threatens sacred sites and ecosystem-linked traditions.
- SIDS (Pacific, Caribbean) face potential loss of entire cultural landscapes.
- Biodiversity loss undermines traditional medicine, agriculture, rituals.

C. Migration and Urbanization

- 114+ million displaced globally → disrupts cultural transmission.
- 56% urban population → weaker intergenerational transfer of intangible cultural heritage (ICH).

D. Economic Pressures

- Creative economy inequality: Developing states face market, IP, and digital access barriers.
- Tourism rebound: Economic benefit vs. over-commercialization and site degradation.
- Uneven recovery: Cultural SMEs in Global South lag post-COVID.

E. Illustrative Case Studies

- **Ukraine:** Conflict damages heritage.
- **Amazon Basin:** Indigenous languages/practices threatened by deforestation.
- **SIDS (Kiribati, Tuvalu):** Cultural displacement due to rising seas.
- **Sahel:** Armed groups target cultural symbols.

F. Regional Hotspots

- **MENA:** Ongoing conflict, fragile recovery.
- **Sub-Saharan Africa:** High linguistic endangerment, insecurity.
- **Asia-Pacific:** Rapid development, displacement; SIDS climate risk.
- **Europe:** Ukraine heritage protection, digitalization, integration.

G. Policy Developments

- UNESCO Conventions (1972, 2003, 2005) central but unevenly implemented.
- UNSC Resolution 2347 reaffirmed (2022–2024).
- UNHRC/OHCHR emphasize indigenous, minority, and displaced cultural rights.

H. Persistent Gaps

- Digital inequality
- Insufficient funding in developing states
- Weak legal protections for indigenous/minority cultures
- Limited community leadership
- Inadequate climate/disaster preparedness
- Weak monitoring in conflict zones

8. UN Past Actions

A. Core Legal Instruments

- **2003 ICH Convention:** Recognizes living, community-based heritage; near-universal ratification.
- **2005 Cultural Diversity Convention:** Protects cultural expressions; links culture to development.
- **Tangible heritage regimes:** 1972 World Heritage, 1954 Hague, 1970 Anti-Trafficking Conventions.

B. Security Council Action

- **UNSC Resolution 2347 (2017):** First resolution solely on cultural heritage; links destruction/trafficking to peace/security.

C. Operational Mechanisms

- **Emergency response:** Documentation, safe havens, repatriation (UNESCO, UNODC, INTERPOL).
- **Capacity-building:** Training, education, policy support under 2003 and 2005 Conventions.

D. Key Challenges

- Uneven national implementation and capacity
- Over-prioritization of monumental heritage
- Chronic underfunding of ICH
- Weak enforcement against trafficking
- Limited grassroots and indigenous participation

E. Assessment

Successes:

- Global recognition of ICH

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- Integration of culture into human rights and security agendas
 - Emergency response capacity

Shortcomings:

- Implementation gaps
- Marginalization of minority/community heritage
- Insufficient funding and enforcement

9. Country Stances / Bloc Positions

Overview: Positions reflect priorities in sovereignty, development, soft power, and indigenous rights.

Selected States

- **USA:** Emphasis on law enforcement, IP, private-sector role; non-ratification of 2003/2005.
- **China:** Ratified key conventions; digital preservation; heritage as soft power.
- **Russia:** Focus on tangible heritage; sovereignty-centered approach.
- **UK:** Strong multilateral engagement; community-based and digital initiatives.
- **France:** Heritage diplomacy; financial and technical support.
- **India:** ICH linked to development and tourism; Global South alignment.
- **Brazil:** Indigenous and Afro-Brazilian heritage; community participation.
- **Saudi Arabia:** Tangible heritage focus; tourism-driven preservation (Vision 2030).

Blocs

- **G77 + China:** Equity, capacity-building, Global South protection.
- **EU:** Multilateralism, digital archiving, post-conflict recovery.
- **NAM:** Sovereignty, resistance to homogenization.
- **AU:** Indigenous heritage, linguistic diversity, local ownership.

10. Possible Solutions

Executive Summary:

A multi-level approach combining legal, economic, technological, and community-based strategies is required.

A. Short-Term (1–3 years)

- Emergency safeguarding and digital repositories
- Stronger anti-trafficking enforcement
- Awareness campaigns targeting youth and communities

B. Medium-Term (3–7 years)

- Capacity-building and regional UNESCO Heritage Hubs
- Heritage-linked sustainable livelihoods
- Legal harmonization with UNESCO conventions
- Cross-border cooperation for shared heritage

C. Long-Term (7–15 years)

- Integration of cultural protection into globalization frameworks
- Cultural literacy and youth engagement
- Permanent UN monitoring units and trust funds
- Expanded research and open-access documentation

D. Cross-Cutting Mechanisms

- Diplomatic safeguards in trade and development agreements
- Digital platforms and virtual museums
- Sustainable financing
- Community-led governance

Here's a **concise, top-10 bullet version** of your QARMA framework for quick readability while keeping all key points:

11. QARMA – Concise Key Points

Q – Key Questions

1. How can UN/SOCHUM help states preserve tangible & intangible heritage without infringing sovereignty?
2. What mechanisms prevent cultural homogenization while promoting cross-cultural exchange?
3. How can technology (digitization, virtual museums) protect endangered heritage?
4. How to balance economic development, tourism, and local culture preservation?
5. How can UNESCO conventions (1970, 1972, 2003, 2005) align with domestic laws?
6. What incentives encourage private sector involvement without commodifying heritage?
7. How should post-conflict & disaster response integrate cultural preservation?
8. How to engage youth & civil society in sustainable cultural initiatives?
9. What measures support cross-border protection of shared heritage?
10. How can Global South countries be supported in capacity building & funding?

A – Actors / Stakeholders

1. **UN Bodies:** UNESCO, SOCHUM, UNDP, UNODC/INTERPOL
2. **NGOs/Civil Society:** ICOMOS, ICCROM, local heritage NGOs, digital preservation platforms
3. **States & Regional Blocs:** Member states, AU, EU, ASEAN, NAM, G77+China
4. **Private Sector:** Cultural tourism operators
5. **Academia:** Universities & research centers in ethnography, anthropology, digital heritage

R – Resources / Research Tasks

1. UNESCO reports on intangible heritage protection (2022–2025)
2. UNGA resolutions & SOCHUM debates on cultural preservation (last 5 years)
3. Ratification status of 2003 & 2005 UNESCO Conventions
4. Domestic laws on cultural property, IP, and heritage protection
5. Case studies of globalization's negative impacts on heritage

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6. Cross-border preservation projects (e.g., Silk Road, Amazon)
 7. Global digital preservation initiatives & tools
 8. Funding mechanisms supporting local cultural enterprises (World Bank, UNDP)
 9. Mapping key actors: NGOs & civil society groups
 10. Regional bloc positions & historical UNESCO/SOCHUM voting patterns

M – Measures / Mechanisms

1. Legislative: Harmonize domestic laws with UNESCO conventions
2. Financial: Establish trust funds for community-based cultural projects
3. Technical: Training, capacity-building, technology transfer
4. Emergency Protection: Rapid response for heritage under threat
5. Cross-Border Cooperation: Shared databases & collaborative programs
6. Public Engagement: Awareness campaigns, heritage festivals, education
7. Private Sector Collaboration: CSR programs for cultural preservation
8. Digital Platforms: Virtual museums, repositories, open-access archives
9. Monitoring & Reporting: Regular heritage threat reports to SOCHUM
10. Youth & Community Inclusion: Integrate local stakeholders in planning

A – Actionable Roadmap

1. Assessment: National & regional surveys of at-risk heritage
2. Legal Alignment: Harmonize domestic laws with UNESCO & UN frameworks
3. Emergency Response: Rapid protection teams & digital repositories
4. Capacity Building: Training, UNESCO Heritage Hubs, technical support
5. Funding & Incentives: Trust funds, grants, private sector incentives
6. Community Engagement: Include local communities, indigenous peoples, youth
7. Cross-Border Cooperation: Collaborative programs for shared cultural assets
8. Technology & Digitalization: Digital archiving, virtual museums, knowledge-sharing
9. Monitoring & Reporting: Periodic reporting to SOCHUM & UNGA Third Committee
10. Review & Adaptation: Revise policies based on research, feedback, globalization trends

SOCHUM Agenda: B

The Role of Social Media in Shaping Public Opinion and Human Rights

1. Introduction to the Topic

Executive Summary:

Social media has become a central force shaping public opinion, political participation, and perceptions of human rights. While it expands access to information and civic engagement, it also creates serious risks for freedom of expression, privacy, social cohesion, and democratic integrity.

Social Media as a Global Information Infrastructure

Social media platforms now form a core part of the global information ecosystem, particularly where traditional media is restricted. Billions rely on these platforms as primary news sources, enabling rapid cross-border information flow. From a human rights perspective, social media has lowered barriers to participation, amplified marginalized voices, and enabled real-time documentation of abuses. UN bodies recognize its dual role as a tool for empowerment and accountability.

Intersection with International Human Rights Law

International human rights law—especially Article 19 of the UDHR and ICCPR—fully applies online, protecting the right to seek, receive, and impart information regardless of frontiers. However, freedom of expression is not absolute. Lawful and necessary restrictions are permitted, creating challenges when private corporations, rather than states, control speech moderation, visibility, and access.

Public Opinion, Algorithms, and Power

Algorithmic content curation prioritizes engagement, often amplifying sensational or polarizing material. UN reports warn that opaque algorithms can distort public discourse, deepen polarization, and undermine informed democratic decision-making. These practices

raise concerns related to equality, non-discrimination, access to information, and corporate accountability.

Opportunities and Risks for Human Rights

Social media has advanced human rights awareness by enabling rapid dissemination of evidence, advocacy, and early warning during crises. At the same time, misuse has fueled hate speech, incitement to violence, and disinformation, sometimes contributing to real-world harm. This dual-use nature requires careful, rights-based governance.

Relevance for SOCHUM

SOCHUM is uniquely positioned to address the humanitarian, social, and cultural impacts of social media, including protection of vulnerable groups and social cohesion. This topic requires balancing freedom of expression with harm prevention in digital spaces.

Key Terms:

Algorithmic Amplification, Freedom of Expression, Digital Public Sphere, Content Governance, Platform Accountability

2. History and Background

Executive Summary:

Since the early 2000s, social media has evolved from a symbol of democratization to a contested space raising serious human rights concerns.

Early Optimism (2000–2010)

The emergence of platforms like Facebook, YouTube, and Twitter transformed communication through user-generated, interactive content. Early UN discourse emphasized expanded access to information and civic participation, particularly in restrictive media environments.

Political Mobilization (2010–2015)

Social media played a visible role in movements such as the Arab uprisings, enabling protest organization and documentation of abuses. In 2012, the UN Human Rights Council affirmed that rights protected offline must also be protected online. This period also saw early censorship, surveillance, and shutdowns.

Disinformation and Harm (2015–2020)

Disinformation campaigns, electoral interference, and online hate speech highlighted how platforms could be weaponized. UN investigations linked social media misuse to polarization and violence, challenging assumptions of inherent democratization.

Platform Accountability (2020–2022)

Debates intensified over corporate responsibility, guided by the UN Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights. The COVID-19 “infodemic” underscored the dangers of misinformation in public health emergencies.

Digital Governance (2022–Present)

UN initiatives such as the Roadmap for Digital Cooperation emphasize global norms to ensure digital technologies serve the public good. SOCHUM’s engagement reflects a shift toward evidence-based, rights-centered governance.

Key Terms:

Digital Activism, Disinformation, Corporate Responsibility, Infodemic

3. Causes

Executive Summary:

Social media’s impact on public opinion and human rights is driven by technological design, economic incentives, political manipulation, regulatory gaps, and social factors.

Key Drivers

- **Algorithms:** Engagement-based curation amplifies polarizing or misleading content; lack of transparency limits accountability.
- **Business Models:** Targeted advertising incentivizes virality over accuracy, disproportionately affecting developing regions and minority languages.
- **Political Manipulation:** Coordinated disinformation undermines democratic participation and public trust.
- **Regulatory Gaps:** Absence of harmonized global regulation leads to either weak oversight or excessive censorship.
- **Digital Literacy:** Limited media literacy increases vulnerability to manipulation, especially among marginalized groups.

Key Terms:

Algorithmic Curation, Targeted Advertising, Regulatory Gaps, Digital Literacy

5. Effects

Executive Summary:

Social media has reshaped freedom of expression, democratic participation, privacy, and social cohesion, producing both empowerment and harm.

Major Effects

- **Freedom of Expression:** Expanded access and advocacy, alongside opaque moderation and disproportionate silencing of marginalized voices.
- **Democratic Processes:** Increased mobilization but weakened trust due to disinformation and manipulation.
- **Social Cohesion:** Rise in online hate speech, harassment, and normalization of discrimination.
- **Privacy:** Extensive data collection enables surveillance and self-censorship.
- **Humanitarian & Cultural Impact:** Improved crisis communication but risk of cultural marginalization and narrative dominance.

Key Terms:

Online Hate Speech, Right to Privacy, Digital Surveillance

6. Current Situation (2024–2025)

Executive Summary:

Social media remains central to public opinion formation amid declining global freedom of expression and growing regulatory tensions.

Key Developments

- Global freedom of expression has declined, with increased censorship and self-censorship.
- Social media has overtaken traditional media as a primary news source, heightening concerns over information integrity.
- States increasingly diverge over digital regulation, balancing free speech and content moderation.
- Civic mobilization via social media remains strong, particularly among youth, but digital divides persist.
- Rising digital authoritarianism involves surveillance, restrictive laws, and platform control.
- Journalists and human rights defenders face escalating physical and digital threats.

Summary of Dynamics

- Social media deeply shapes public opinion.
- Expression is increasingly constrained.
- Regulatory conflict is growing.
- Platforms enable both empowerment and repression.
- Information integrity and journalist safety are under strain.

7. UN Past Actions:

Core UN Position

The United Nations has consistently affirmed that **international human rights law applies fully online**, including on social media platforms. UN action focuses on **freedom of expression, access to information, privacy, safety, and platform accountability** within digital governance.

Key UN Instruments

Human Rights Council

- **A/HRC/RES/32/13 (2016) and A/HRC/38/L.10/Rev.1 (2018)**
 - Confirms that rights offline apply online
 - Protects freedom of expression, privacy, and access to information
 - Calls for digital inclusion, media literacy, journalist safety, and action against online harassment, hate speech, and misinformation
 - Condemns unjustified internet shutdowns and information flow disruptions

General Assembly

- **A/RES/78/213 (2023)** — *Human rights in the context of digital technologies*
 - Applies human rights obligations across the full lifecycle of digital technologies
 - Stresses state and non-state responsibility
 - Encourages cooperation between governments, platforms, and civil society

Global Digital Compact (Pact for the Future)

- Anchors digital governance in **human rights, inclusion, safety, and accountability**
- Calls for safeguards against online harm, human rights due diligence, digital literacy, and equitable access
- Promotes **multi-stakeholder cooperation** as a global standard

UNESCO & Supplementary Actions

- UNESCO supports UNHRC resolutions and leads work on **platform governance, information integrity, and journalist safety**
- Emphasizes media freedom, ethical platform design, and inclusive digital spaces

Snapshot Table

UN Body	Action	Core Focus
UNHRC	A/HRC/32/13	Rights apply online
UNHRC	A/HRC/38/L.10/Rev.1	Expression, safety, privacy
UNGA	A/RES/78/213	Digital human rights
UNGA	Global Digital Compact	Human-rights-based digital governance

Country & Bloc Positions:

United States

- Strongly prioritizes **freedom of expression**
- Opposes foreign regulations viewed as censorship (e.g., EU DSA)
- Uses sovereignty-based arguments in digital governance
- Tension between security measures and free speech protections

Position: Free speech first

Concern: Over-regulation and extraterritorial censorship

European Union

- Supports **robust platform regulation** (DSA)
- Emphasizes transparency, accountability, and online safety
- Sees content moderation as compatible with human rights

Position: Balanced regulation

Concern: Combating harmful content while preserving rights

China

- Advocates **cyber sovereignty and state control**
- Prioritizes social stability over unrestricted expression
- Resists Western digital rights framing

Position: State-led governance

Concern: National control over information space

India

- Supports regulation against misinformation and violence
- Recognizes constitutional free speech but faces proportionality concerns

Position: Regulated digital participation

Concern: Preventing harm without suppressing dissent

Brazil

- Actively enforces **platform accountability**
- Courts allow liability for hate speech and anti-democratic content

Position: Judicial enforcement

Concern: Protecting democracy and public order

South Africa

- Emphasizes **inclusive digital rights**
- Focuses on access, equality, and protection of vulnerable groups

Position: Rights-based inclusion

Concern: Digital inequality

Pakistan

- Prioritizes **national security and public order**
- Uses platform restrictions during sensitive periods
- Faces criticism for disproportionate controls

Position: Security-driven regulation

Concern: Balancing order and expression

Russia

- Supports strong state regulation and sovereignty
- Rejects Western models of open digital governance

Position: Sovereignty-first

Concern: External interference

Bloc Positions

- **G77 + China:** Sovereignty, development, non-interference
- **NAM:** Access, capacity building, fairness
- **Freedom Online Coalition:** Rights offline = rights online

Possible Solutions

Short-Term (Immediate – 1 year)

- Establish **emergency content-response protocols** during elections, conflicts, and humanitarian crises
- Require **platform transparency reports** on content moderation and takedowns
- Strengthen **rapid fact-checking partnerships** with UN agencies and civil society
- Protect **journalists and human rights defenders online** through reporting and support mechanisms

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- Condemn and limit **unlawful internet shutdowns**
 - Launch **public digital literacy campaigns** targeting youth and vulnerable groups

Medium-Term (1–5 years)

- Develop **human-rights-based national social media regulations** aligned with ICCPR
- Mandate **algorithmic risk assessments** and independent audits
- Establish **independent digital oversight bodies** at national or regional levels
- Expand **media literacy education** into school curricula
- Create **regional cooperation frameworks** to address cross-border disinformation
- Encourage **platform due diligence** under UN Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights

Long-Term (5–10 years)

- Negotiate **international norms or guidelines** for platform accountability under UN auspices
- Institutionalize **multi-stakeholder digital governance** (states, platforms, civil society, academia)
- Build **global early-warning systems** for online incitement and mass disinformation
- Ensure **equitable digital access** to reduce information inequality
- Integrate **information integrity standards** into global trade and development frameworks

Cross-Cutting Measures

- Uphold **freedom of expression with proportional limitations**
- Ensure **transparency, due process, and appeal mechanisms**
- Center **community protection and inclusion**, especially for minorities

QARMA

Q — Key Questions for Debate

1. How can freedom of expression online be protected while limiting hate speech and incitement?
2. What legal obligations do states have under ICCPR Article 19 in digital spaces?
3. How should platforms balance content moderation, transparency, and user privacy?
4. What role should algorithms play in shaping public discourse, and how can they be regulated?
5. How can states prevent disinformation during elections and crises without censorship?
6. What accountability mechanisms exist for social media companies under international standards?
7. How can digital literacy reduce misinformation and polarization?
8. How can multi-stakeholder digital governance be practically implemented at national and UN levels?

A — Actors / Stakeholders

- **States:** Governments, election authorities, digital ministries
- **UN Bodies:** OHCHR, UNESCO, UNDP, UNHRC, IGF
- **Technology Companies:** Meta, X/Twitter, Google/YouTube, TikTok
- **Civil Society:** Article 19, Access Now, Human Rights Watch
- **Media:** Reuters, BBC, Al Jazeera
- **Academia:** Oxford Internet Institute, RAND, Chatham House

R — Resources & Research Tasks

- OHCHR reports on **freedom of expression online**
- UNESCO **Guidelines for Digital Platform Governance**
- UN Secretary-General **Policy Brief on Information Integrity**
- ICCPR Articles **19 (expression)** and **25 (participation)**
- UN Guiding Principles on **Business & Human Rights**
- Reuters case studies on **disinformation and platform regulation**

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- Global Digital Compact & **Pact for the Future**
 - UNICEF & UNESCO work on **media and digital literacy**

M — Measures & Mechanisms

- **Legal:** Human-rights-based digital laws aligned with ICCPR
- **Policy:** National digital governance strategies
- **Technical:** Algorithmic transparency & independent audits
- **Oversight:** Multi-stakeholder regulatory bodies
- **Monitoring:** Platform transparency reports & risk assessments
- **Cooperation:** Regional and UN-led digital governance forums

A — Actionable Roadmap

Short-Term (1–2 years)

1. Mandate platform **transparency reports**
2. Launch **digital literacy campaigns**
3. Protect **journalists and activists online**
4. Establish **election & crisis response protocols**

Medium-Term (3–5 years)

5. Create **multi-stakeholder digital councils**
6. Enact **platform accountability laws**
7. Require **algorithmic risk assessments**

Long-Term (5+ years)

8. Develop **international digital governance standards**
9. Establish a **UN-linked observatory** on social media impacts
10. Institutionalize **global cooperation on information integrity**

Here is the **APA-style bibliography** for the **10 core sources**, formatted cleanly and ready to paste into a **study guide, position paper, or background guide**.

Research Links:

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